

Sally Berson

CONTACT	3400 N Charles Street, Baltimore, MD 21218	email: sberson1@jh.edu website: sallyberson.github.io
EDUCATION	Ph.D., Psychological & Brain Sciences, Johns Hopkins University Advisor: Lisa Feigenson	2023 – present
	BA, Cognitive Science BA, Biopsychology, Cognition, & Neuroscience University of Michigan <i>with distinction and high honors</i>	2019 – 2023

HONORS, AWARDS, & FELLOWSHIPS	Diverse Intelligences Natural & Artificial Minds Fellowship, <i>Princeton University</i>	2026 2025
	Graduate Research Fellowship Honorable Mention, <i>National Science Foundation</i>	2023
	Phi Beta Kappa Honor Society	
	High Honors for Senior Thesis, <i>University of Michigan</i>	2023
	James B. Angell Scholar, <i>University of Michigan</i>	2021 – 2023
	University Honors, <i>University of Michigan</i>	2019 – 2023
CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS	Berson, S., Feigenson, L., (2026). Infants evaluate and generate explanations for surprising events. Talk to be presented at the 52 nd Annual Meeting of the Society for Philosophy & Psychology. Baltimore, MD	
	Berson, S., Feigenson, L., (2026). Can infants generate explanations? Poster presented at the Cognitive Development Society Conference. Montréal, QC	
	Berson, S., Feigenson, L., (2025). Core knowledge influences explanatory reasoning. Poster presented at the 47 th Annual Conference of the Cognitive Science Society. San Francisco, CA	
	Berson, S., Feigenson, L., (2025). Children’s explanations for surprising events. Poster presented at the 51 st Annual Meeting of the Society for Philosophy & Psychology. Ithaca, NY	
PUBLICATIONS		
<i>Journal Articles</i>	Berson, S., Feigenson, L., (in prep). The role of knowledge and motivation in children’s explanation evaluation.	
	Berson, S., Feigenson, L., Liu, S., (forthcoming). Core perception cannot ignore issues of conceptual content and functional role [commentary]. <i>Behavioral and Brain Sciences</i> .	
	Berson, S., Pappagallo, E., Ripley, O., Zehner, A. (2023). Preferential Unconscious Attention for Pictures over Words in a Visual Recognition Paradigm. <i>The Canadian Undergraduate Journal of Cognitive Science</i> .	

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE	Graduate Student Researcher	2023 – present
	Laboratory for Child Development Johns Hopkins University Principal Investigators: Lisa Feigenson, Justin Halberda	
	Undergraduate Research Assistant	2019 – 2023
	Neuropsychology and Cognitive Aging Lab University of Michigan Principal Investigator: Laura Zahodne	
	Undergraduate Research Assistant	2022
	Cognitive Neuroscience of Consciousness Lab Danish Institute for Study Abroad Principal Investigator: Claudia Carrara-Augustenberg	
MENTORSHIP		
<i>Undergraduate Students</i>	Samuel Vidomlanski, Johns Hopkins University	2026 –
	Aliza Tharani, Johns Hopkins University	2026 –
	Shayan Lalani, University of Georgia	2026
	Chloe Patz, Wake Forest University	2025 – 2026
	Esther Kehinde*, Johns Hopkins University	2025 – 2026
	Claire Han, Johns Hopkins University	2025 – 2026
	Priscilla Animadu*, Johns Hopkins University	2024 – 2026
	Natalie Bernstein, Johns Hopkins University	2024
	*indicates honors student	
TEACHING		
<i>Graduate Teaching Assistant</i>	Introduction to Psychology, <i>Johns Hopkins University</i>	2026
<i>Graduate Teaching Assistant</i>	Introduction to Cognitive Psychology, <i>Johns Hopkins University</i>	2026
<i>Graduate Teaching Assistant</i>	Research Methods in Psychology, <i>Johns Hopkins University</i>	2025
<i>Graduate Teaching Assistant & Guest Lecturer</i>	Introduction to Developmental Psychology, <i>Johns Hopkins University</i>	2024